

UX Case Study

Flipkart — Shopping App & Website Experience

An analysis of the end-to-end user journey, key strengths and friction points, with three proposed improvements supported by low-fidelity wireframe sketches.

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1. Introduction & Methodology

Flipkart is one of India's largest e-commerce platforms, used daily by millions of shoppers across electronics, fashion, groceries, and general merchandise. This case study evaluates the core shopping journey — from discovering a product to receiving it — using a heuristic walkthrough of the mobile app, informed by general usability principles (Nielsen's heuristics, mobile commerce best practices) rather than internal analytics or user interviews.

Scope: the analysis focuses on a first-time-intent shopping task — searching for a product, comparing options, and completing a purchase — since this is the highest-stakes flow for both the user and the business.

Method: a structured walkthrough of five journey stages (Discovery, Browse & Search, Product Page, Cart & Checkout, Delivery & Post-purchase), noting friction and delight at each step, followed by a prioritized set of improvement proposals.

2. User Journey Map

The map below traces a typical purchase journey, plotting the user's emotional state against each stage and flagging the primary friction point encountered.

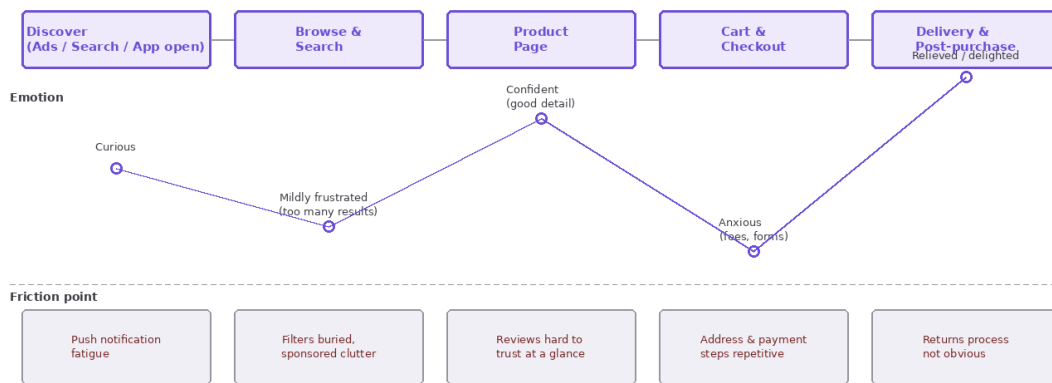


Fig. 1 — Current user journey: Discovery to Post-purchase

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3. Strengths

- **Deep product information:** specifications, seller ratings, and Q&A sections give confident buyers enough detail to decide without leaving the app.
- **Flexible payment options:** EMI, Pay Later, and Cash on Delivery lower the barrier to purchase for a wide range of price points and users.
- **Strong logistics visibility:** order tracking with delivery-partner updates reduces post-purchase anxiety, which is one of the highest-friction moments in online shopping.
- **Personalized discovery:** browsing history and recently-viewed sections make it easy to resume an interrupted shopping session.
- **Membership layer (Flipkart Plus):** gives frequent shoppers a clear, tangible reason to stay on-platform rather than price-compare elsewhere.

4. Weaknesses

- **Search results are ad-heavy:** sponsored listings are visually similar to organic results, making it harder to judge relevance at a glance.
- **Filters are buried:** once applied, filters are easy to lose track of, and there's no persistent indicator of what's currently active.
- **Trust signals are scattered:** rating, return policy, and delivery estimate live in different parts of the product page instead of being visible together near the buy action.
- **Checkout lacks a sense of progress:** each step feels like a fresh screen with no indication of how many steps remain or what the final cost will be until the last step.
- **Notification fatigue:** frequent price-drop and reminder notifications can desensitize users, reducing the effectiveness of genuinely useful alerts.

5. Proposed Improvements

Improvement 1 — Surface trust signals & add a sticky Add-to-Cart bar

Move rating count, delivery estimate, and return window into a single summary block directly under the price, and pin the price + Add-to-Cart action to the bottom of the screen so it's available without scrolling back up. This shortens the path to purchase and reduces the cognitive load of hunting for reassurance signals.

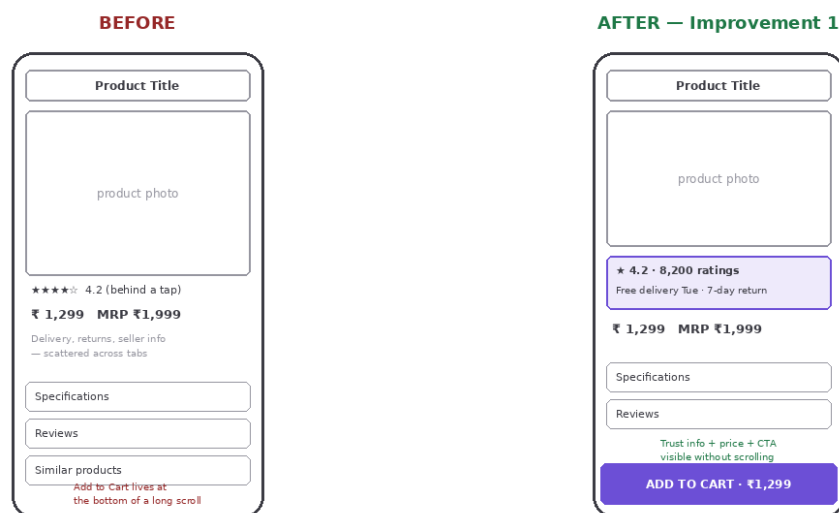


Fig. 2 — Product page: trust signals surfaced, sticky Add-to-Cart bar

Fig. 2 — Product page: trust signals grouped, sticky Add-to-Cart bar

Improvement 2 — Persistent filter chips & clearer ad labeling

Keep applied filters visible as removable chips pinned under the search bar, so users always know what's currently narrowing their results. Cap the density of sponsored listings and label them consistently, so users can quickly distinguish paid placements from organic ones.

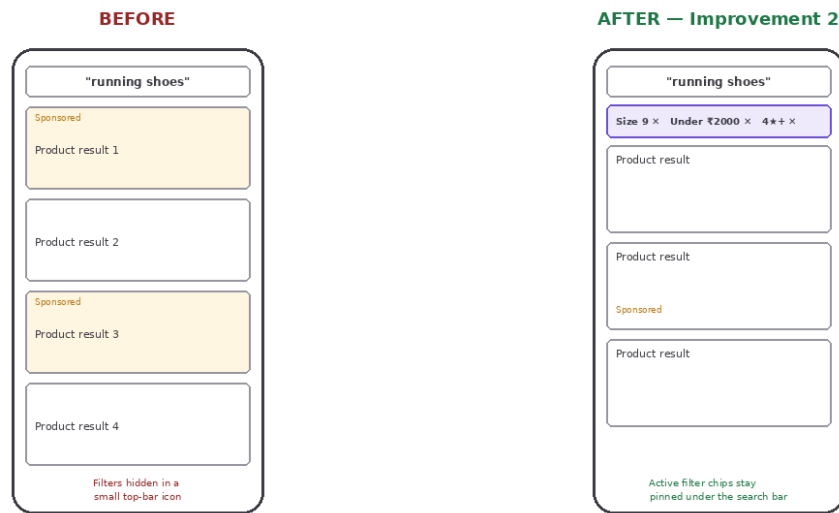


Fig. 3 — Search results: persistent filter chips, sponsored items clearly labeled and capped

Fig. 3 — Search results: persistent filter chips, clearly capped and labeled sponsored items

Improvement 3 — Visible checkout progress & up-front total

Replace the sequence of unlabeled screens with a simple 4-step progress bar and show the full order total, including delivery fees, from the very first checkout step. Removing last-step surprises is one of the most effective ways to reduce cart abandonment.

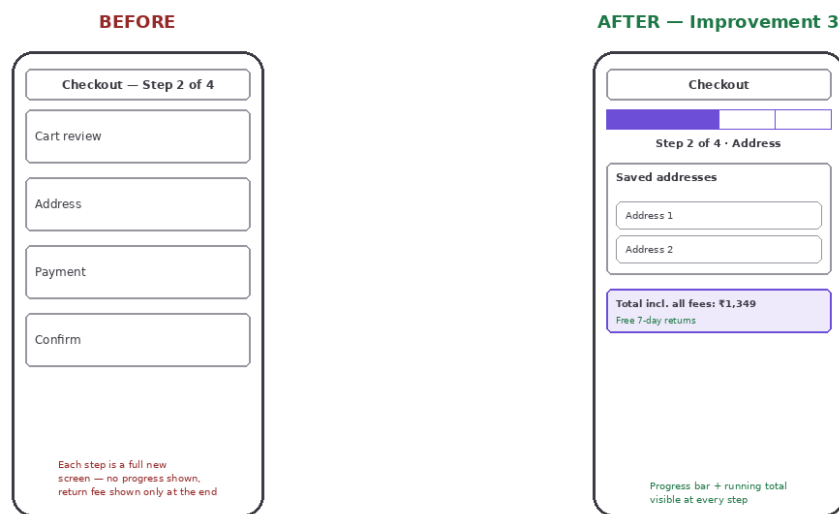


Fig. 4 — Checkout: visible progress and up-front cost breakdown

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6. Expected Impact

Improvement	Primary metric	Expected effect
Sticky trust bar	Add-to-cart rate	Fewer drop-offs from re-scrolling to find price / CTA
Persistent filters	Search-to-product CTR	Faster narrowing, less re-filtering, more relevant clicks
Checkout progress + total	Cart abandonment rate	Fewer exits caused by unexpected fees at the last step

7. Conclusion

Flipkart's core strengths — deep product information, flexible payments, and reliable delivery tracking — form a solid foundation of trust. The main opportunities lie not in adding new features, but in reducing friction at three specific decision points: the product page, the search results list, and checkout. Grouping trust signals, keeping filters persistent, and showing checkout progress with an up-front total are small, targeted changes that directly address the moments where users are most likely to hesitate or abandon their purchase.